An incredible 3-month internship at TRG International! 🔥

Here's what I've done and the meaningful contributions I'm proud to share:

Technical Milestones

☆ Built 2 virtual agents to send event notifications to 150+ employees

☆ Developed a version control tool for Word documents

☆ Automated address geocoding and collected geospatial datasets for custom mapping

☆ Managed SOP documents across departments and cross-functional teams

☆ Created training materials for Learning & Development initiatives

☆ Assisted in sourcing marketing leads and partnerships

Soft Skills & **Leadership Highlights**

✿ Won the title "Star Intern" 🌟 thanks to positive contributions

✿ Represented TRG at career fairs, won the 'Most Interactive Company' title and drew 200+ applicants

✿ Spearheaded a personal growth sharing session with the CEO

✿ Delivered a speech to the HR team: "Vocal Power: Speak to Be Heard, Speak to Be Felt"

✿ Conducted behavioral interviews for incoming interns and assisted in full-time employee hiring processes

✿ Onboarded new interns and led SOP training sessions

✿ Took the acting lead role in TRG's advertisement project

✿ Organized internal events: "Employee of the Month", "Knowledge Sharing", biweekly icebreakers, and office tours

✿ Participated in CSR opportunities: blood donation, tree planting, and charity meal delivery

Thank you Kiranjit Grover for creating a respectful and welcoming team environment ~ Thank you Tien Luong Ngoc Thuy for being a great leader and providing helpful feedforward ~ Thank you Võ Xuân Quyên for giving me advices on even the smallest things, being an amazing supervisor and also a great friend ~ Thank you Lê Thiên Nhi for always being supportive and giving me recruitment tips and insights ~ Thank you Hoài Thư Mai for consistently correcting my bad habits ~ Lastly, thank you to the rest of the HR team, fellow interns, and TRG members for always believing in me and letting me go above and beyond! I would never expect myself to learn so much in just 3 months!

#Internship #Intern #LastDay #TRG #SOP #Programming #HR #CareerGrowth #Vietnam

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Project Lead

• Cooperate as a team to build custom software solutions for social good
• Led scrum agile framework for a 10-person development team, resulting in a 40% increase in project delivery speed

Vice President of Technology
• Collaborate with 6 technical associates to revamp the UTMSAM website
• Lead the creation of the EmberHacks website
• Spearhead EmberHacks, a 48-hour hackathon, attracting students across 3 UofT campuses
• Host workshops on web development, LeetCode, AI, and quantitative tools (MATLAB, SageMath, LaTeX, etc.
• Seek out for potential partners and sponsorships

Standard Operation Procedure Intern
• Earned the title "Star Intern" 🌟
• Built a virtual agent that sends event notifications for up to 150+ employees, improving efficiency by 200%
• Developed a version control tool for offline Word documents to enhance workflow.
• Automated address geocoding and compiling geospatial datasets for map visualizations of 150+ employees
• Worked with department leads and cross-functional teams to streamline process flows and refine SOPs
• Represented TRG at career fairs, seek out for new talented interns and contribute to the first-round interviewing processes
• Hosted Q/A sharing session between the CEO and 20+ interns

Computer Science & Math Mentor
• Conducted weekly tutoring sessions for first-year students at University of Toronto in Computer Science (OOP and DSA) and Math (proofs)
• Contributed 600+ helpful responses on UofT course platforms
• Provided academic support to students in weekly office hours
• Turned complex concepts into digestible ideas, improved average grades by 15%, received 100% positive feedbacks from students

Design Technology Ambassador
• Facilitated 3 departmental welcoming events, introducing 120+ parents and students from up to 52 nationalities to Design Technology
• Showcased engaging presentations and 3D CAD softwares, including aluminum die-casting and woodworking activities

Create and Care
• Led team of 8 to teach 20 students handmade product design such as clay models, totebags, keychains, etc.
• Managed sales effort at 3 events with 2,000+ guests
• Coordinated sales operations at seasonal events to raise money for charity

Content Creator & Video Editor
• Managed a YouTube channel with 3,000,000+ total views over two years
• Researched for new content, edited videos, designed thumbnails and performed analysis on audience's behaviors
• Took on freelance video projects, including event highlights, music videos, and gaming content

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4x more participants than expected, thank you everyone for coming! 🦔
My first year orientation felt like yesterday. Now as a second year student, I'm excited to bring back the same energy from last year. Before the event even began, I spent 7 hours straight at the tabling event with my team, spreading the word about CodeQuest!

We led students into the world of hedgehogs and explore the UTM campus, while solving tricky, but exciting problems related to Math and Computer Science. Along the way, they were asked to snap selfies to prove their progress, but most importantly, to create unforgettable memories.

With the support of an amazing team, we made it happen seamlessly. Special thanks to Raweeha Raza for her brilliant ideas and dedication in preparing the venue. Huge shoutout to my incredible tech team: Mustafa Bhatti and Daniel Halpern for keeping everything running smoothly.

Also, a special thanks to Moeez Omair for bringing the UTMSAM team together, and to @Arjun Jayakrishna, Alishba Mateen, Aryan Aryan, and @Aditya Ilham for their effort throughout the day. And of course, a big shoutout to Aarav Pradhan for creating all the awesome graphics!

Stay tuned for what's to come in the school year, I will see you all soon!

#UofT #UTM #Orientation #2025 #CodeQuest #UTMSAM

7 hours to make something out of nothing. We built an app that transforms healthcare at TechTO Hackathon! 🩺
I arrived two hours early to the event, only to be told by the receptionist that the event didn't exist! For a moment, I thought I had the wrong day—until I met Chantal Nguyen, and we realized we were just really early.

As a solo hacker, I was placed in a team with three incredible individuals: Yakshith Kommineni, Ishan Shah, and Danny Hu. All three were so so smart, and together we built OperAid — a voice-controlled tool to help doctors access patient data, scans, and notes without touching a keyboard.

Based on our research, a doctor spends on average 2 minutes per patient just to look up their information, which is prone to human errors, especially during late night shifts. Our solution is

simple, simply say “Pull up Jack’s MRI scans”, and the following files will appear! It was a collaborative effort where we had to generate a database of over 500+ patients, create a minimalist frontend, work on the backend for voice recognition and information lookup, make a skit for demo, and finally put them together as a website…in just 7 hours!

After the event, I got to explore the city with my amazing “tour guide” Emi Sun who introduced me to a cozy Japanese restaurant and a bubble tea spot! I totally did not expect a 12-hour event to bring so many new memories and opportunities for me to meet new friends.

This was one of the fastest but most meaningful events I've been part of. Thank you Samit Khalsa for hosting this event. And thank you to everyone who made it special.

#TechTO #Hackathon #12HourChallenge #OperAid #VoiceAI #HealthcareInnovation

Skipped my midterm to visit the Google office in Toronto, was it worth it? 🔵🟢🟡🔴
By far, the most impressive office I’ve ever visited! From a game room with PlayStation, pool, and football tables to indoor golf, the fun never stops. There are also music production rooms, 3D printing labs, and even a cozy corner for pets. And the food? From Asian cuisines to Western classics, there will always be something that matches your taste. There was also a secret door built into the wall…WHAT?

The most unique thing about this Google office was how each floor and room is designed around Canadian culture, with themes celebrating famous places and people from across the country. As an international student who is still exploring Canada, it was amazing to experience how deeply Google embraces and celebrates its roots in the local culture.

The event wasn’t just about the office tour, it was also an incredible learning experience. I had the chance to meet like-minded friends (), chat with current Googlers ( ) about their exciting career journeys, and gain insights that will definitely help shape my future. A huge thank you to Jelena for organizing this fantastic experience!

This experience has truly motivated me to push even harder in my own journey. One day, I hope to call this place home.

#Google #Canada #Toronto #King #OfficeTour #NewExperience

EmberHacks 2025 — UTMSAM’s First Hackathon! 🔥
This weekend, we hosted EmberHacks, UTMSAM’s first-ever hackathon — 36 hours of innovation and creativity! Our mission was to bring UofT students together to build projects around the theme of Education, and with over 120+ hackers signed-up and countless inspiring submissions, it was an incredible success.

Our judges ranged from software developers to professors, and several projects even caught the attention of faculty members, some may soon be implemented in real courses! Teams built amazing tools like an integrated VS plugin for students, accessibility apps supporting those with dyslexia, and platforms connecting courses' knowledge to help students visualize their educational path ways.

Huge thanks to Professor Rutwa, Professor Josh, Steven from MLH, our judges, sponsors, and organizers for making this event possible. It was an honour working with such passionate people and seeing everyone's ideas come to life.

The hackers' hard work was paid off with awesome prizes, from airpods and headphones to gaming mice and more! We even hosted a cup-stacking challenge, and the winner of cup stacking also took first place in the hackathon!

Staying overnight, meeting new friends, and watching this event coming together was an unforgettable experience. I can't wait to do this again next year and continue building the legacy of EmberHacks. 🚀

We are hackathon winners at GoOnHacks! 🏆

This hackathon was all about weird ideas. Me, @phin, and @shrey teamed up (none of us had ever built a Chrome extension before) and created one that uses image detection and recognition algorithms to find every human face on your browser… and turns them all into LeBron James.

It works everywhere - Google Images, Instagram, even your emails. Every face? LeBron. We even added a feature so you can pat LeBron on the screen (because, why not show the King some love?) and a Twitter bot that counts how many times you see LeBron and tweets about it - tagging celebrities, of course.

Despite the

Throughout the event, we met amazing people, from the founder of GoOnHacks @zach, to the founders of TypeOS who gave us resume tips, and tons of other brilliant hackers. We have seen projects ranging from a chair that automatically chases you, electrocute kit, and also a game controller made out of AirPods.

It was great learning new tools, 30 hours of hacking, and having fun. We are amazed that out of 800 of those who signed up, 200 hackers coming to the event, our project stood out to the judges! We even got free labubus at the end for having the best pitch! Here is the demo video to our project if anyone is interested: https://youtu.be/ppbUnvcdWOQ?si=X8kTeZufT3U6IeJg

Huge thanks to everyone who made GoOnHacks such a blast (literally) - can't wait to come back next year for round two! Woohoo!

#Winner #GoOnHacks#Hackathon #30hour #UofT #Waterloo #Kitchener #Canada

500+ people in the room, and I got the mic. 🎤
Google's DevFest 2025 in Toronto was the biggest hands-on workshop I've ever attended — and also the first time I pushed myself to step up, take the mic, and ask questions in front of a crowd that size.

Instead of hopping between talks, I spent the entire day building, experimenting, and breaking things (on purpose) with Google Cloud and Gemini CLI AI agent. We were guided through practical labs that took us from zero to deploying a real ML-powered Gmail add-on.

The workshops were highly interactive, filled with passionate developers, students, and industry professionals who were all there to experiment and learn. I met so many amazing people, had the chance to listen to great keynote speakers (@naveen, @punit), and chat with incredible mentors (@nick, @oliver, @ghaleb). And of course, a shoutout to the new friends I made (@garima, @...) and the friends who came along (@richelle, @phin, @hung, @guneev, @manj, @gilbert).

Really looking forward to more events like this, so @omar and @alex, I'm counting on you to make it happen LOL.

hashtag#DevFest hashtag#GoogleCloud hashtag#AI hashtag#GCP hashtag#TorontoTech hashtag#GDGCloudToronto hashtag#DeveloperCommunity

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#Google #Canada #Toronto #King #OfficeTour #NewExperience

I arrived at the Deloitte and was immediately surrounded by the most well-dressed people! 🥂

I had the incredible opportunity to enter the consulting world and visit the Deloitte office in Toronto. From beautifully designed open-concept workspaces to quiet corners for deep focus, the office seems to strike the perfect balance between professionalism and comfort. My favourite part was the beautifully designed stairs in the center, where all floors are connected elegantly. And of course, the views of downtown Toronto were absolutely breathtaking.

But the highlight of this visit wasn't just the environment, it was the people. I got to connect with amazing students and speak with Deloitte professionals who generously shared their experiences in consulting, technology, and strategy. From what I learned, Deloitte employees can choose their own "personality group," and the company provides a platform that connects people with similar working styles so they can collaborate more effectively.

A huge thank you to @kacy for making this visit possible, and to everyone who took the time to chat with us. I hope to have a chance to work with you all in the future!

#Deloitte #Toronto #OfficeTour #Consulting #Innovation #NewExperience #CareerJourney

I have 5 final exams, **but I'd never be too busy for the Shopify office tour**! 🛍️
Unlimited snacks, 3D printed candies, indoor karaoke, movie room, yoga studio, upside down garden, ping pong tables, red room, a car inside the office…? These were just a few out of all the unique things I saw at the Shopify office. It was mind-blowing.

The space is filled with unique architectural designs that make every corner feel like a new environment. But as always, the highlight wasn't just the fun. I had the opportunity to speak with the VP, Head of Engineering at Shopify, @farhan, and the insights I gained from that conversation were truly eye-opening. One takeaway that has stayed with me is his reminder that "your growth accelerates when you surround yourself with brilliant people and lean into the toughest problems." I've been consciously applying this mindset to my daily life ever since.

I also had the chance to connect with incredible people—@curtis, @alexa, and @larissa—each of whom brought inspiring perspectives and energy to the event. Through our conversations, I gained a much deeper understanding of Shopify's culture and what the future application process might look like. I'm truly grateful for the insights they shared.

A huge thank you to @phinn for coming with me, and an even bigger thank you to @zoey and @rui for hosting this unforgettable experience. I really hope you guys will organize more office tours next year!

This visit left me more motivated than ever to keep pushing forward. One day, I hope to contribute to a place as innovative as Shopify.

Dear Jack in 2024,
Starting 2025, you won't know how to code, all you know are for loops and if statements that you learned last year. You will start doing something scary called "applying to jobs", which you will, and give up after 20 postings because it is too tiring. But luckily, you get offered two on-campus positions and one summer internship in TRG's HR team.

For the entire Winter semester, the only thing you will chase is the Teaching Assistant position. You soon participate in class, go to office hours every week, and contribute to hundreds of comments on courses' forums. You will participate in your first hackathon, get carried by a 4th year student, and win 2nd place ($100!). After this huge win, starting April, you begin working on your first ever personal project. It's simply a command-line interface app, but you will love it!

Then summer comes, spoiler alert, you force yourself to learn software development every single day. You won't know what a frontend or backend is, but trust me, you soon will! During your internship, you will use the knowledge you have learnt, and create apps for your HR workflow, good job Jack!

Mid summer, you realize the TA position is only for 3rd years, your heart breaks. You start looking into clubs, and apply to 30+ positions. You will land a Vice-President position at UTMSAM, and use this as leverage, to become the Project Lead at UofT Blueprint. Then, you get a Research Assistant role, thanks to the guidance of upper year mentors. Lastly, you will also join the organizing team of GenAI Genesis. Starting your 2nd year, you won't be a TA, but you will have 5 positions to juggle around.

You will get a chance to participate in Canada's largest hackathon and witness a Guinness World Record. After this, you fall in love with hackathons, and continue to join 4 more (as a hacker, a mentor, and an organizer). Yes, you will host your own hackathon for 100+ people! Not just that, you will go to every event out there, from networking, info sessions, career fairs, to office tours. Your favorite memories will soon be performing card tricks at career fairs to impress

companies. Every time you go on an office tour, you make a LinkedIn post about it, specifically, you will go to Microsoft, Amazon, Google, Shopify, Deloitte, I am not kidding.

Most importantly, you seek out mentors, make new friends, and establish great relationships, don't forget them, Jack! You will apply to more than 500 jobs this semester (and land 3 interviews!), no job offers though…but don't give up. Every opportunity given to you, grab on and make the most of them!

Don't be so worried, because you will go solo-traveling for the first time. You fly 4,500km to visit Vancouver, and come to a Halloween party for future founders, unbelievable right? By the end of 2025, you apply to many more events for 2026, and you are starting your own club next year. Yes, as a founder!

Good luck Jack, it can only get better, keep going!

Best,
Jack in 2025

We analyzed 1.6M+ flight records to let planes fly like birds ✈️
Last weekend at DeltaHacks, our team asked a simple question: if birds fly thousands of miles in formation without getting tired, why can't planes do the same?

Turns out, they can. Aircraft flying in V-formation, or simply behind each other, can significantly reduce drag, air resistance, and thus optimize airspace by 4%. These small interactions added up can save millions of tons of CO_2 annually, per plane. Why is it not a reality yet? No one has figured out how to find which flights can actually pair up using such a large amount of data.

So me, Amaar A, Shubham Garg, and Marc Da Silva came together to build SkySync. We produced over 300K flight pairs using 1.6M+ flight data and techniques such as Haversine distance, heading alignment, and temporal overlap, then applied gradient descent to find fuel-optimal departure times. The algorithm fetches for flights within North America, calculates their best formation paths, and visualizes all interactions on a 3D globe.

You can literally watch multiple planes join up, fly together, and split off to their destinations with live fuel savings ticking up in real-time (in our demo below!).

Beyond the hacking, DeltaHacks was a great experience. I watched sponsors build what looked like a mini Apple Store right inside the venue. Also, I connected with amazing recruiters like Antonio Santino Slaybe who gave genuine career (and food) advice and fun facts about Manulife. There was also a fire drill happened! Finally, somewhere between the free snacks and energy drinks, I met my friends who I had no idea were also coming.

Huge thanks to my teammates again for pushing through the all-nighter. And thank you DeltaHacks for hosting such an incredible event at McMaster, it was my first time here and I will definitely come back!

Check out our project here, take a look (the demo starts at 1:40!):
https://devpost.com/software/skysync-wapxj0

#Planes #Innovation #DeltaHacks #Hackathon #SkySync #ClimateAction #McMaster #Canada

Back to back hackathon, this time we made a tool that teaches you to do anything online 👩‍🏫
Before diving into technical stuff, last weekend made me realize that the real treasure was the friends we made along the way. With over 600 hackers, I managed to chat with the brightest students who share the same passion. Huge thanks to my teammates @, @, @ for bringing this project to life and walking away with $600 worth of cash and rewards as a team.

It was a pleasure to meet @, @, @, @ who was supposed to be the "enemy team", but we ended up supporting each other, joining events, and eating “good food” together. Hopefully, in the future we will be real teammates!

Oops, went a bit too far, back to the project, we created Big Brother. This Chrome extension helps older adults navigate any websites through natural language instructions. The theme was "Identity". So we wanted to give elderly people a new “internet identity”, teaching them how to explore the web, a skill that most Gen Z's take for granted!

For example, this tool can go on Facebook's Marketplace, find relevant products, and put them to carts, or even send text messages to sellers for price negotiations!

We combined multiple AI models for semantic searching pipelines and integrated voice-controlled functionalities for accessibility. Along with MongoDB, Voyage AI, and FastAPI, we were able to implement a RAG system, caching layers, and context graphs for real-time memory.

Lastly, one of the coolest parts of the hackathon was the app experience, participants could earn "hackbux" (hacker money) to buy exclusive merchandise! There were of course, amazing sponsors such as @, @, @, @, and many more. And I still can’t get over how some of the prize tracks offer direct internships for the winning teams (I really do need an internship, gosh…).

Thanks for reading and you can check out our project here. 100% recommend the demo video, you will have fun watching it:
https://devpost.com/software/big-bro-tsv0i9

#UofTHacks #Hackathon #Innovation #AI #ChromeExtension #BigBrother #Accessibility

I am competing for $20,000 at Stan 💸
No, this is not a MrBeast video, it is a hackathon hosted by Hack AI and Stan. 60 builders are selected. We have 48 hours to build an AI-powered video-editing platform.

Thank you to Stan and Hack AI for sponsoring this event. And shout out to @James, @Esther, and @Emily for bringing this event together.

Finally, @Vitalii, I will build something that impresses you.

5/48 hours into the hackathon, we know we will win.
Today I have met the brightest founders and builders around the world, many from Europe.

Again, big thanks to James Cao, Esther Wang, and Emily Talas for hosting the event, for the free wifi, free food, free drinks, everything!

I had a chance to meet Stan's CTO, Vitalii Dodonov. "Building is easy - distribution is hard" - said Vitalii, which is why I am here to build the next gen AI video editing tool, combining Premiere Pro flexibility and iPhone simplicity.

The Head of Engineering, Ricky P. gave us insights on Stan's tech stack, and we decide to build our app 100% with technologies that Stan uses.

That's it for today, it's past midnight, and we are still building. More updates in the future. Look forward to posting about our win soon.

#hackaitoronto #Stan #HackAI #20K

Back to back to back hackathon, I won't enjoy hackathon anymore 😭
Not because I am tired of them, but this one set the standard too high. Sashimi, salmon, steak (perfect medium rare) for dinner? Meeting the greatest engineers from seniors to founders? Professional photography team flying from Vancouver? Excuse me?

I had the chance to fight for $20,000 with @ and @, sadly…we didn't win, but guess what I won: I learned from @ how to turn an open-source project into my own unique app. From @, I learned how to read documentation properly, extracting key details and choosing the right AI models for the job. I learned from @ how to use AI effectively: not as a shortcut, but as a real

building buddy that amplifies how you think and execute. @ taught me how a solution architect thinks, @ shows me how a perfect speech looks like. Thank you @ for offering me a ginger shot lol!

Beyond the learning, the experience itself was unreal. The food was next-level. And the production team @ absolutely blew me away. They captured every small moment throughout the event, and at the end surprised us with a room full of printed photos, plus a personal letter for each builder, with our own memories beautifully printed. That meant more than I can put into words. Thank you @, @, @, and the rest of their team for that!

Huge thank you to everyone who made this possible. Again, @, @, @, @, @, @. I walked away inspired, grateful, and more motivated than ever to keep building. I hope we will cross path again in the future.

Also check out our demo video, I spent 3 hours recording and editing it!
#Hackathon #Stan #HackAI #Builders #Startups #AI #Grateful #KeepBuilding

Back to back to back to back hackathon, we won software category in a hardware hackathon 🏆
UTRA Hacks was a hardware hackathon, and I hate hardware...Somehow, I still walked away with a win!

I attempted to help assemble the car, tighten screws, and watch the robot slowly destroy itself (broken axles count: 37). Motors failed, sensors drifted, screws vanished into thin air. Kudos to Arav Patel, Teghveer Singh Ateliey, Rehan Abbasi, Phineas Truong for allowing me to experience this with them.

While the team battled physics, I went on a mission to build a software project. And with the help from Ezra Song and Phineas Truong, I managed to build a live, interactive 3D showcase of our robot that you can explore and DRIVE IT YOURSELF (more info at the end).

The system uses ElevenLabs and Google Gemini for reasoning to identify, explain, and highlight robot parts in real time, with dynamic animation, and catchy sound effects. Click a component and it responds with immersive audio, and you can also set up your own car engine sound for the drive test!

The car is modeled by hand, by Arav Patel, such that it is exactly the same as our real life model. This masterpiece won us the ElevenLabs award! Feel free drive test the car with WASD controls, B for speed-boost, and Shift to brake: https://yellow-brownies.vercel.app/

More information about how we built the robot itself can be found at:
https://devpost.com/software/banana-brownies

Would I do a hardware hackathon again as a software engineer? Absolutely. Would I touch the hardware parts? Maybe not for me...But regardless, thank you so much to ULTRA Hacks for hosting such an exciting hackathon. Thank you Alina Momin for believing in us and reward us with brand new earbuds.

Also a big shout out to my friends whom I met throughout the hackathon, it was super fun to see you guys at these events. See you guys again soon!

#Winner #UTRAHacks #Hackathon #Software #Hardware #3D #AI #Robotics #ElevenLabs #Gemini

Back to back to back to back to back hackathon, the mayor invited us back to Kingston to pitch for $10,000 🏆
We created a 3D 1:1 replica map of Kingston where you can design your own buildings, with customizable sizes, materials, and surroundings, to be placed on the map.

There are live simulations using Kingston dataset of over 4,500+ buildings and 700+ roads. Each car movement around the site, road blockage, or pedestrian sidewalk is all animated in real time. Huge thanks to Phineas Truong, Vihaan Sharma, and Dhan Narula for working on this project with me.

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This won us the City of Kingston challenge, giving us a gold ticket to present this idea to the mayor! Thank you Craig Desjardins for giving us this opportunity, see you on March 20th!

Check out our project here, I spent too much effort on editing the video! https://lnkd.in/eyAz9sgf

Beyond the project, QHacks itself was CRAZY. Somewhere during the hackathon we “recruited” three hackathon organizers as undercover agents (Agent 67 Rounika Saxena, Agent 69 Ashmaan Sohail, and Agent 1 Jose Kerketta) to scout other teams for us - purely for fun, of course. Also to Jason Chen for giving us extra demo time.

Finally, we spent 30 minutes flipping water bottles until we finally landed a synchronized double trick shot. Also, there are trees inside this campus...?

Transportation-wise, we traveled 5 hours through a snowstorm in −25°C weather to get there, the bus arrived 1 hour late. When everything ended, we booked an Uber to take us to the bus stop. First car came, and literally drove off (because he saw 4 luggages coming). Then, we had

to wait for the second Uber, 6 km to go, 10 minutes until the bus took off. Our driver went on fast and furious mode and got us there in time, we tipped him 100%! The bus was just about to take off, and we could have been stranded in a different city overnight.

I met so many friends here, and learned a lot from their cool projects including Alexander He Meng, Aum Soni, and Marc Da Silva. Also, can someone find me the contact of the guy who could play guitar behind his back, and playing guitar and harmonica at the same time?

This will not be the end, it is a beginning, we are now coming for that $10,000 in Kingston, everyone watch out!

#Winner #QHacks #Queens #Hackathon #KingstonInnovation #Challenge #3D #Building #AI #ElevenLabs #Gemini

I went to Amazon office, not the one for humans, but the one where robots live 🤖
I arrived at Amazon's fulfillment center, waiting to be fulfilled. And yes, I was satisfied by just witnessing over 10,000 robots operating in perfect coordination, in an 850,000-square-foot factory.

They took all of our phones, so I couldn't capture images inside (but a stock image is attached below), thus my memory will be shallow, but here were what I took away from the tour:

- Each floor, 1,000 robots moved constantly with no traffic accidents! (even when a human came into the matrix, the robots will navigate around them)
- Each robot can carry up to 700 pounds
- AI is utilized in the process to track exactly where all packages are going
- Computer vision detected exactly the size of the items, dispensed the correct box and tape sizes efficiently
- The angle and color of workstation lighting is optimized in a way to improve the employee's focus (backed by psychology!)
- There were multiplayer games where employees can compete in to see who earns more points (by packing more items)
- More than 13 miles of conveyor belts were running non-stop
- The entire ecosystem took into consideration the size, the weight of each item, where it was heading, the drop-off dates, who was the buyer, the seller, etc.
- A wall of names was decorated to honor loyal employees, some worked here for 15 years

Funny enough, this tour made me realize AI and robots still couldn't replace humans just yet, as some of the packages flew off the conveyor belt LOL, but it rarely happened.

Seeing how software translates into physical motion at this scale was surreal. It reminded me that behind every “Order” button is an ecosystem of AI, automation, and engineering behind the screen.

Massive respect to the engineers who design systems like this.

hashtag#Amazon hashtag#Robotics hashtag#AI hashtag#ComputerVision hashtag#SupplyChain hashtag#Fulfillment hashtag#Brampton hashtag#Engineering

Back to back to back to back to back to back hackathon, I left midway…😓
(6th hackathon in a row) Last weekend, I joined the AI Agents Voice Hackathon. Fully online. No venue. No free food. No random 3AM talks. Just sitting at the Toronto Public Library with Discord opened.

To be honest, I don’t like online hackathons. Even though I reunited with my amazing friends from the Stan Hackathon (@, @, @), but without the in-person chaos and pressure, I felt a bit lost.

Still, we built Composium. This app allows you to use your voice to sing, and musical beats would play along to back you up! I focused on organizing Github tickets, setting up audio pipelines, and finishing features that converted voices to ABC notes. We pushed through bugs, implemented voice integrations, and stitched together the AI agent flow.

And here’s my guilty confession, it's Valentine’s Day. I thought sitting at my computer for an entire day was too sad, so I left to go to the aquarium. When I came back, my team had squashed the remaining bugs and finalized the app. We ended up placing 13th out of 200 hackers, and I was super proud of my teammates for what they have done. @ and @ are amazing, and thank you @ for stepping outside of her comfort zone as a VC to join a hackathon.

But I wish I had contributed more in those final hours. Even though I stepped away, my teammates didn’t. I don’t think I will do any online hackathon anymore, and I definitely won't leave to go to an aquarium.

Back to in-person hacking soon.

#AI #Hackathon #Agents #Voice #Online #Waterloo #Composium #Aquarium #Valentines

Make an app that impacts people ❌
Make an app that impacts people you love ✅

This Lunar New Year, I can't come home to visit my family, so I decided to build an app to let me send new year wishes to them. The design is inspired by the Vietnamese colors, with "gold bling" animations as gold represents good luck in Vietnam.

The app contains my entire family tree, each person can click on the coin with their name, and receive a lì xì (lucky money) envelope, with a little message from me. My family can also send images back since I implemented a photobooth feature!

I had a week to build this. At first, the photoshoot feature doesn't capture well, the envelope animations were bad, and the videos didn't even load. I had to learn video optimization techniques, video caching, and figure out the best storage option.

Before, I kept wondering how to build impactful projects, how to get millions of users...but this project made me realize that meaningful things come from those you love. So building something to make them happy is all you need.

Happy Lunar Year everyone, chúc mừng năm mới!

#Family #Tet #NewYear #Lixi #Project #Building

Back to back to back to back to back to back to back hackathon, we won TWICE at a dental hackathon with zero dentistry experience 🦷 (7th hackathon in a row)
With negative dental knowledge, we got 3rd place overall 🥉 and the best photo/video award 🏆, the only team with 2 wins! Thank you so much Hasan Malik, @Kasey Sung, and Pascal Petherick for sharing these memories with me!

We built a dual-view web app that allows patients to communicate with their dentists and see how their jaws look in 3D! We created an AI pipeline that takes CT scans and updates the 3D model accordingly, like (cavities spots or missing teeth). Both doctors and patients can leave annotations on specific teeth, add notes, and revisit the model anytime after the appointment. There are even chewing animations to simulate potential pain in a patient's jaw, depending on their conditions.

@Kasey Sung reached out to dozens of dentists in Ontario, even got on a phone call with one, they agreed that this project is a must-have! But beyond the fancy certificates, we received $225 in cash, a direct interview opportunity with NEST, and interest from Balbir Sohi, MSc, RDH OMTP who will potentially work with us in the long term.

Some random memories: we ran through the rain to grab McDonald's, we wrote our entire plan on a ~1km long whiteboard, then me and @Kasey Sung went to eat korean bbq LOL (so

yummy). Also, it's funny how I have not met Hasan Malik in 9 months. We got randomly matched up in a team, reconnected, and won the hackathon!

Also, congratulations to Han Hsu, Aleksey Goroshko, Danai Adamopoulos and Jaehyuk Lee as well! Their team won first, and their products were so cool! They even finished the physical design of their models as well, dominating the hardware category.

After this hackathon, I will definitely brush my teeth better and keep them clean haha. And you should too!

#SmileHacks #Hackathon #Streak #Winner #Dentistry #AI #3D #HealthcareTech #Startup #Toronto

Back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back hackathon, I solo'ed this one 😨 (8th hackathon in a row)

I both hacked and mentored at DeerHacks V LOL. On the same weekend, I went to the Tech Roast Show, had a fancy dinner at Piano Piano, and led a workshop for University of Toronto Society for Algorithmic Modelling.

But back to the hackathon, I built Hands Tiles, a computer vision rhythm game where you play piano tiles with your hands. Did I win? No. But I finished a full project, with real time tap detection, voice hype announcements, scoring system, and users could input music sheets to be played directly in the app.

Somewhere in between building and debugging, I left the hackathon to grab dinner at a nice restaurant, then went to Tech Roast in Toronto (I got to meet Jesse Warren, Austin Nasso, Nikita Oster in person finally). I also met founders (Shawon Ibn Kamal), builders, and "rappers". The show was hilarious, definitely recommended for everyone!

From the show, I also found that 35% of the audience was unemployed (I was one of them).

At midnight, I came back to DeerHacks, continued hacking, designing, coding, studying, all at once. It was great to meet old and new friends (George Farag, Vihaan Sharma, Dhan Narula, Amogh Merudi, Maryam Elhamidi, Muhammad Taimoor Aleem , Riaa Sehgal, Kimberly Nguyen, and Dipal Hingorani). And I was surprised by how many recognized me for SOON. It is coming guys, get hyped! 🔥

I also attended the intern panels, meeting the crackest people ever and learning from them: Arhum Shahzad, Marwan Yousef, Ben Fogerty, Yousef Abdelhadi and Amaan Farooqi!

Lastly, my workshop was about vibe coding, and I taught Diego Pachas how to use an AI agent for the first time, he was shocked of how much it can do.

See you guys next week for another hackathon!

#DeerHacks #Hackathon #SoloHack #Piano #ComputerVision #WebAudio #Tech #Roast

Back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back hackathon, I did 3 hackathons last weekend 💻💻💻 (9th-11th hackathon in a row)

On Friday, I wrapped up our demo for Hack The Future. Then I began Hack Canada that same day. Saturday, I went back to Toronto to start off Hack The Globe (2-week long project). Finally came back to Hack Canada in Waterloo that night to finish our project, and got a win 🏆!

At Hack Canada, we built ERoute, a smart emergency routing platform for Ontario that helps patients find the best hospital based on their condition, live traffic, and ER congestion. We added a government planning mode where planners can build 3D models of hospitals, adjust capacity, and instantly see how patient flow changes across the network. Thank you Dhanika Botejue (smartest high school student I know), Amogh Merudi (he broke his arm during the hackathon…), and Phineas Truong for building this with me!

For Hack The Future, we created Omni, an supply chain resilience agent that monitors disruption signals, assesses risk, and proposes mitigation strategies. Omni behaves like an AI operations co-pilot, combining live data, and risk reasoning to help mid-market manufacturers! And we made it to the semi-final round, coming this Monday! We got this Kimberly Nguyen, Yeonjoo Kim, Phuong Anh Dang, Maira Masroor!

For Hack The Globe, we are still in the ideation stage, so see you in 2 weeks! Let’s do this Devi Dahlia, Hanum Sukma Zahrani, Phineas Truong!

Besides the 5 hours commute between the two cities, I had amazing food experiences at Hack Canada (the butter chicken was peak, thank you James Cao for hosting this hackathon!). Then, Hack The Globe and BCG offered us unlimited sushi for lunch, which was so delicious.

Throughout the weekend, I had a chance to reconnect with Rosie Wang (happy birthday!), Alison, Marc Da Silva (he is on a 5 hackathon streak!) and also to meet new guys like Jerry Jiang and John Xu! Also shout out to my boy George Farag for building an entire heat camera helmet for firefighters.

Finally, I came to CUCAI AI conference as well, on the same weekend!

You can check out the two projects I worked on here:
- Hack The Future: https://github.com/phuonganhdangamy/htf-agent-zero
- Hack Canada: https://github.com/phintruong/ERoute

The school year is almost ending and so is my hackathon streak, so let's enjoy the final ones together! I will keep going until there is no more hackathon!

#HackTheFuture #HackCanada #HackTheGlobe #Hackathon #Winner #Streak #Canada #Toronto #SOON

WE WON 1ST PLACE AT HACK THE FUTURE 🥇

2 months ago, I was in the audience at the Google office. 2 months later, I found myself in the same room, but on stage, pitching our project - Omni. Thank you Kimberly Nguyen, Yeonjoo Kim, Maira Masroor, Phuong Anh Dang for the 2 weeks of memories and winning the finals together, $1500, at Google, out of 250 participants!

Here were the random things that happened throughout our journey:

- 15 minutes before the demo, our product stopped working, I was fixing bugs while other teams were presenting as the clock was ticking down

- We prepared a 144-page planning documents with carefully-researched materials

- Countless hours were poured into the perfect pitch, my team delivered it flawlessly (meanwhile I still forgot my lines)

- We spent many nights hopping on calls for hours to discuss about Omni

- I was shy and personally felt underdressed as I wore a quarter zip in a sea of suits (because I don't have suit)

- I missed the deadline to sign up at the Google office, and luckily Justin Fan and UofT Project Club managed to find my information and signed me in!

As mentioned in a previous post, we created Omni, a supply chain agent that monitors disruption signals, assesses risk, and proposes mitigation strategies. We aim to save mid-market manufacturing companies hundreds of millions of dollars!

Again, thank you so much to my team for this amazing achievement. For many of us, this is our first time winning first place, and for many more, this is their first hackathon!

Personally, this will mark my 6th win during my 10 hackathon streak. Hopefully more will come, it has been a crazy journey!

You can check out our presentation here: https://lnkd.in/e3kgDgKd
And our project here: https://lnkd.in/eSWvSf9t

#HackTheFuture #Hackathon #First #Winner #SupplyChain #AI #Agents #Omni #Google #Toronto #Canada #Streak

Back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back hackathon, **I organized this one** 💡 (**12th hackathon in a row**)

As a director, I:
- Ran across buildings (back to back to back...)
- Followed schedule minute by minute
- Survived on 4 hours of sleep
- Blew a million balloons (by mouth)
- Organized this, while protests happened outside
- Stood in the cold giving out merch
- Dabbed up friends (too many to count)
- Brought actually good food
- Got fried chicken (with 7 different dipping sauces)
- Set up spicy ramen (food eating competitions

- Moved gaming chairs across the street
- Managed volunteers (they were amazing)
- Handled significant delays
- Played board games
- Checked out amazing projects
- Broke some stuff (our banner and card)
- Dealt with 3 separate emergencies

…and many more crazy stuff I can't recall.

THANK YOU to my boss Stuti Sapru (GOATed) and my team of directors: Han Kong, Om Patel, Kristie Ho, Yu-An Chen for making this event possible. And also to the VPs of GenAI Genesis Alankrit Verma, Hasleen Kaur, and Ivan Semenov.

Thank you to my friends for coming to the event, and to the new friends I made along the way. Next time, come tell me a joke and I will give you extra fried chicken.

Huge congratulations to Marc Da Silva for going on his 6th hackathon in a row and still winning this one, and to George Farag for winning his 3rd hackathon in a row. And to my boy Phineas Truong for helping out with the food.

Shout out to the volunteers, the hackers, the judges, the organizers, and every random chaotic moments. Without these things, it wouldn't be GenAI Genesis 2026!

I can't wait to organize SOON, soon, my very own hackathon that I founded. Check it out guys, fill out the interest form here! https://forms.gle/xJ8iCDawUB4CL2Uu9

#GenAIGenesis #2026 #Hackathon #Tech #Director #Leadership #Building #Hackers #Community #Organizer #Startups

It has been one year since I started coding 🎊

March 19th, 2025. This was when I started building projects. My first ever app was a resume builder. Then I raw coded, not knowing what AI agents are for the next 6 months.

Fast forward 1 year, I finished 30+ projects. I have been to 16 hackathons, 12 within 2026, won 8 of them, hosted 2 hackathons, and founded 1, SOON .

THANK YOU everyone who has been through this journey with me, you are all amazing. I have learnt a lot from all of my friends, mentors, and strangers (that turned into friends) from all of the events.

700+ job applications in and I still have no internship, yet, LOL. But having a chance to visit Google (3 times), Shopify, Microsoft, Deloitte,…offices was really special.

Can't forget all the networking events that I went to, as an attendee, and sometimes as a speaker. I always try to be the dumbest in the room!

One big thing I learnt is that it's never too late to start. Just take action. Set a goal, and do whatever you can think of to achieve it: skip classes, go meet people, sign up for everything. Just keep going and doors will open.

If something is in your way? "Break the rules. Don't ask for permission, ask for forgiveness." - This is my biggest lesson yet.

#1year #Anniversary #Coding #Projects #Building #Hackathon #SOON

Back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back hackathon, **I wrapped up 2 hackathons** 🏙️🗣️ (13th hackathon in a row)

Last weekend, I was in 2 cities (Kingston and Toronto) to wrap up Kingston Mayor's Innovation Challenge (continuation from QHacks) and Hack The Globe.

I won neither of them, but maybe the prizes are the friends we made along the way =).

In Kingston, we spent $150 each to travel back to Kingston, stayed for a night, and arrived at the city hall to pitch to the mayor. As an international student, having a chance to meet the mayor of a city was a crazy experience. We were extremely proud of our

urban planning tool with 3D real-time simulations and analytics. Safe to say, our project was the most technically complex!

But everything before that was great memories, from coding on the bus, getting free dairy queen ice cream, to keeping our hotel awake the entire night (thanks to our pitch practices). All memories were shared with @, @, and @. Again, thank you @ for having us at the event, it was such a unique opportunity!

Back in Toronto, me, @, @, and @ entered Hack The Globe to try solve problems that are often overlooked. We created a platform to allow people with hearing disabilities to practice and carry out interviews with sign languages. This project was truly meaningful, and I couldn't ask for a better team!

But again, it was all about the journey along the way. We walked across Toronto, 11pm at night trying to find a place to sit. We went above ground to underground, board game cafes to Korean bingsu places, from BCG office to back home. Not to mention, we also spent 30 minutes waiting in line to eat at marugame udon! And the highest stake moment was Sunday morning where we all overslept and passed the deadline, and the organizing team was kind enough to grant us a chance to present. Thank you Global Spark!

Overall, it was a tiring weekend of commuting, walking, and hacking. But I love it! Here are the links to our projects:
- Kingston Mayor's Innovation Challenge:
https://www.canva.com/design/DAHEI5Ebgzg/lxOUb1N2emlR53XC-VXsBA/view?utm_content=DAHEI5Ebgzg&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=uniquelinks&utlId=h0e2512923d
- Hack The Globe:
https://devpost.com/software/vibe-voice-inclusion-for-better-employment

#Kingston #MayorInnovationChallenge #QHacks #HackTheGlobe #Hackathon #Streak #Canada #Toronto

Day in a life of a SOON organizer!! Would you be one?

Besides hopping on late night calls, meeting ups for content, and going to networking events to represent SOON, our team has a pretty good work SOON balance.

If you are passionate about creating new experiences for hackers and building an event Canada's tech community has never seen before, feel free to reach out to potentially have a spot as SOON organizers!

Fill in the interest form at https://soonhackathon.ca/ now whether you are a hacker, or a potential partner wanting to make this happen with us!

Back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back to back hackathon, **we won stupid hackathon**! (14th hackathon in a row)

We are bringing you back to 2016. Imagine a working web browser that only returns results from 2016, with interfaces, ads, and every interaction bringing you back to 10 years ago. We won the hackathon 🏆, with prizes being fidget spinners, dino costume, and an iPhone!

Last Saturday, me, @, and @ brought back 2016: Google, Youtube, Twitter, Vines, Spotify, Musical.ly, Tumblr, Cool Math Games, Clash Royale, Harambe, Trump vs Hillary elections, Logan Paul, water bottle flips, clowns, Pokemon GO, damn Daniel's, mannequin challenge, fidget spinner, dabbing, etc.

All of these are not just the frontend but a fully functional backend, including Youtube live features, real vines videos, working chess games with AI ML algorithms, real-time voting, functional bottle flips (you have to flip your laptop), functional pokeball, etc. etc.

We made all of this in 4 hours in total. This was the fastest hackathon/hackathon win I have ever done!

#2016 #Ideas #Stupid #Hackathon #Hackathon #Streak #Canada #Toronto

SOON application is out! **40 hackers**. **1 private house**. **1 weekend**!!!!!!

Visit https://soonhackathon.ca/. We will create the most memorable hackathon ever. Concepts you've never seen before, storylines you will never expect, and friends you will never forget. Come join us today!

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- Sponsors: SOON offers four benefit pipelines tailored to what your company: hiring, branding, product, and founders.

- Food Partners: Have SOON feature your brand in our promotions, brandings, and a “secret film”.

- Community Partners: Collaborate with SOON to create content and support each other!

All information can be found at https://soonhackathon.ca/. Let's create Something Out Of Nothing together!

#SOON #Hackathon #Hacker #Application #Live #Sponsor #PrivateHouse #Interest #Giveaway